

February

23

Also on this day

1807 **The Slave Trade Act**, proposed by William Wilberforce to abolish the slave trade in the British Empire, was approved by Parliament.

1987 **Astronomers spotted light** from Supernova 1987A, an exploding star. This was the first supernova to be studied in detail.

2019 **Argentinian footballer Lionel Messi** scored his 50th hat-trick for FC Barcelona as they beat Sevilla 4–2 to top the Spanish League.



1954

Polio vaccine

The first injections of the polio vaccine were given to children at Arsenal Elementary School in Pittsburgh, USA. Developed by US doctor Jonas Salk, the vaccine was used to protect millions from the disease.



1945

Marines on Mount Suribachi

During the Battle of Iwo Jima, US marines raised their national flag on Mount Suribachi on the Pacific island of Iwo Jima after reaching the summit of the mountain. US forces later took control of the Japanese island.

Born this day

1868 W E B Du Bois, Black American civil rights activist. He co-founded the National Association for the Advancement of Colored People (NAACP).

532

Hagia Sophia

Byzantine emperor Justinian I ordered the construction of a grand Christian church that would become the centre of the Eastern Orthodox faith for almost 1,000 years. Hagia Sophia still stands today in Istanbul, Turkey, but it is now a mosque.

